

JHANAVI SANKAR

jsankar@andrew.cmu.edu | (412) 512-8953 | www.linkedin.com/in/jhanavisankar | Portfolio: <https://jhsankar.github.io/>

EDUCATION

Carnegie Mellon University, Heinz College	2026
Master of Science in Public Policy & Management	GPA: 3.90
Delhi University, Lady Shri Ram College	2021
Bachelor of Arts, Honors, Sociology	

RESEARCH INTERESTS & SKILLS

Research Profile: Skilled in applying AI in policy and economic contexts. Expertise in quantitative research methods, analysis of RCTs, and evaluation of AI applications in multiple policy domains including education and the labor market, philanthropy, and renewable energy.

Analytical Skills: Regression Methods, Machine Learning methods, Excel, PowerPoint, Power BI, SQL, R, Python, Generative AI tools for research synthesis, ArcGIS Pro

Relevant coursework: Applied Econometrics, Statistical Methods, Applied Economic Analysis, Operationalizing AI

Leadership & Recognition: Dean's List for Academic Achievement, Editor for the Heinz Policy Journal, Teaching Assistant for five courses

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Plus, Personalized Learning Lab, Carnegie Mellon University	August 2025 – Present
Research Assistant (Professor Danielle Thomas)	
- Synthesized evidence from RCTs across four K-8 schools in the U.S. to evaluate how an AI-enabled tutoring intervention affects learning outcomes across student subgroups - Modeled the relationship between student engagement (time-on-task, lesson mastery) and learning gains using advanced statistical methods in R, testing alternative specifications to assess robustness - Translated quantitative findings into research notes and visualizations for academic and practitioner audiences	
Pittsburgh Public Schools	June 2025 – August 2025
Data and Reporting (Power BI Analytics)	
- Designed Power BI dashboards and SQL pipelines integrating administrative data across 54 K-12 public schools in the Pittsburgh region, helping district leadership target academic and behavioral support to students based on identified need - Authored three executive insight reports translating quantitative analyses into decision-ready recommendations for district leadership	
Teach for India	May 2022 – May 2024
Fellow Advisor and Fellow	
- Drove an average 1.5 grade-level reading gain across 200+ students in under-resourced schools through state-aligned literacy programming and data-informed instructional planning - Coordinated cross-functional implementation across schools, partner organizations, and government stakeholders	

PROJECTS

KM Strategies Group, AI for Public Good	January 2026 – May 2026
- Prototyped a data-driven grantmaking tool for nonprofits in Pennsylvania to help under-resourced organizations identify aligned funders without manual research effort, using public philanthropic datasets to rank funding opportunities matched to organizational mission and capacity - Integrated a Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG) pipeline with the OpenAI API to automate funder research that nonprofit staff would otherwise conduct manually, enabling faster synthesis of funder priorities - Developed a responsible AI governance toolkit to help nonprofit organizations evaluate AI adoption risks without requiring technical expertise, including risk assessment checklists, bias-mitigation guidance, and implementation standards grounded in established governance frameworks	
Financing Equity in Education, Independent Study	August 2025 – December 2025
- Evaluated education financing systems in Vietnam and the Philippines as contrasting cases in Southeast Asian school finance, analyzing how differences in funding formulas, governance structures, and regional allocation produced different equity and learning outcomes - Developed evidence-based policy recommendations on weighted student funding, teacher support, performance monitoring, and early-childhood investment, translating findings into a school-finance reform framework for low- and middle-income policymakers	

U.S. Clean Energy Tariff Strategy

August 2025 – December 2025

- Modeled three U.S. tariff strategies on Chinese solar and battery imports using multi-attribute utility analysis across six stakeholder groups, evaluating how trade policy choices produce different welfare and supply-chain outcomes under competing economic and geopolitical objectives
- Stress-tested recommendations through sensitivity analysis under multiple scenarios including international retaliation and policy rollback, grounding analysis in regulatory and industry data

Policy Innovation Lab × U.S. Census Bureau, Carnegie Mellon University

October 2024 – December 2024

- Built an integrated workforce dataset linking O*NET occupational task data with federal Business Trends and Outlook Survey (BTOS) firm-level data on generative AI adoption, addressing a gap in federal evidence on which occupations are most exposed to AI to inform workforce planning
- Synthesized interviews with stakeholders into a structured analytical framework that prioritized which AI-affected occupational categories required further federal data collection and policy attention